

WE'RE PROBABLY GONNA DIE IN THESE WOODS

The best way to learn is to play its game. Use the rest of this as a reference as you play.

What is this?

WE'RE PROBABLY GONNA DIE IN THESE WOODS is a storytelling-roleplaying game.

Players control the actions of a group of travelers as they navigate the woods.

Unfortunately, the woods are a perilous place, haunted by the ghosts of past travelers. By the end of your travels, one of your party will likely have joined the ranks of these lost souls. It is your goal to avoid this terrible fate!

What do I need?

This game requires 4-6 players at a recommended age of 13+. A standard game takes 2-3 hours. Each player needs a QR-enabled phone or device and a deck of Woods cards.

The deck contains:

- 40x pre-designed Woods Cards
- 1x 'Tutorial' Card
- 5x Chapter Cards (numbered 1 - 5)
- 1x 'Epilogue' card
- 1x 'Set-Up'

How to begin?

Find the Set-Up card in the deck. All players should scan its QR code on their own devices, then follow the instructions together.

Alternatively, all players can scan the Set-Up QR code below:



What's gonna happen?

The game is broken up into the following distinct chapters.

Chapter 0: Set-Up - Set up the game.

Chapter 1: The Inn - Establish your character and meet your fellow travelers.

Chapter 2: The Thicket - The first leg of your journey.

Chapter 3: The Mire - The second leg of your journey.

Chapter 4: The Gorge - The final leg of your journey.

Chapter 5: The Heart of the Woods - The Woods demands their toll: a traveler's soul. Maybe yours...

Chapter 6: Epilogue - What became of those who escaped the Wood?

What's all this on the cards?

Number: In the top left corner is the card's number. This will sometimes be referenced in encounters during chapters 1-4.

Suit: In the top right of each card is a suit: Scrolls, Moons, or Cups. This suit will sometimes be referenced in chapters 2-4. In tiebreaker scenarios, Scrolls beat Moons beat Cups.

Name: The name of the spirit that haunts the Woods (if drawn in ch. 2-4) or the archetype for character creation (if drawn in ch. 1).

Bargain: The action that this spirit will demand of a traveler if it strikes a Bargain with them.

OR code: Used to access information about the card, depending on which chapter it appears within.

What're are all these terms?

Bargain: Sometimes, instead of granting its Blessing to a traveler (see below), a spirit might instead offer a conditional protection called a Bargain. Bargains symbolise a trade between the spirit and the traveler; the spirit protects the traveler, but its influence affects the traveler's behaviour. The traveler must obey the Bargain rules written on the spirit's card so long as they possess the Bargain. In return, the spirit will convert its Bargain to a Blessing in the Heart of the Wood, thus helping the traveler survive. Travelers who win a Bargain should place the Bargain card face-up to one side of their Character Card, so that they can read the card's Bargain rules.

Blessing: When a spirit is pleased, it might grant its special protection to a particular traveler.

Spirits who have bestowed a member of the party with their Blessing travel invisibly with them and will help to protect them when they reach the Heart of the Wood. Travelers who win a Blessing should place the Blessing behind their Character Card so that the spirit's name and number are still visible.

Challenge:	Minigames posed by card encounters. Challenges are a spirit's way of testing the travelers' skills. Depending on how the travelers fare, Challenges can bestow Blessings, Bargains, or Curses on the party.
Conundrum:	Difficult decisions imposed by card encounters. Conundrums are a spirit's way of testing the travelers' characters. Depending on the party's choices, Conundrums can bestow Blessings, Bargains, or Curses.
Curse:	When a spirit is displeased in a Challenge or Conundrum, it will lay its Curse upon the party. The more Curses a party gathers, the more lives will be claimed in the Heart of the Wood. Furthermore, if a party incurs three Curses, the Woods will reject them, and they will be forced to flee for their lives. When you incur a Curse, place it in a chosen area of the table so that all travelers are aware of it.
Deck:	Woods Cards that are not dealt into the Path or as Character Cards at the top of the game become the deck. At the end of each encounter, any cards on the table that are not Blessings, Bargains, Curses, Character Cards, or Path cards should be reformed into the deck.
Discard:	To discard a card during an encounter, place it in a pile to one side. At the end of the encounter, return this discard pile to the deck.
Encounters:	Encounters comprise the day phase in Chapters 2-4. Most encounters pose the party with some kind of Challenge or Conundrum, from which Blessings, Bargains, and Curses might be won.
Gorge:	The third, most treacherous section of the woods, passed through in Chapter 4.
Item:	Items - selected early in the game - represent important, emotionally-charged objects in a traveler's possession. Upon gaining an Item, players select objects from around their place of play to represent it at the table. Items may come in useful at certain times, or they may simply serve as character-building props.
Marked for Death: least	In Chapter 5 — earlier, if three Curses occur — the heart of the woods will choose at least one sacrifice from among the party. When a traveler is Marked for Death in this way, they may protect themselves by discarding a Blessing. If the traveler cannot protect themselves, they are claimed and perish.
Mire:	The second section of the woods, through which travelers pass in Chapter 3.
Party:	The whole group of travelers.

Path:	Constructed in Set-Up, the Path is a special deck that represents a party's unique journey through the woods; it also determines the encounters that a party will meet on their journey. The game begins when the first card in the Path is scanned; it ends when no cards remain. From the top card down, a standard Path deck is built like so: • Chapter 1 • Chapter 2 • 3x Woods Cards • Chapter 3 • 3x Woods Cards • Chapter 4 • 3x Woods Cards • Chapter 5 • Chapter 6
Reader: as well as	Readers communicate Challenge and Conundrum rules to the rest of the party, lead discussions in the night phase. Unless stated otherwise, only the current Reader should scan cards on the Path and read the associated text. At the end of most nights, the role of Reader rotates left.
Spirit:	The spirits that haunt the woods are represented by Woods Cards in Chapters 2-4. Pleased spirits can help protect travelers by bestowing their Blessing or Bargain. However, angry spirits can curse the party.
Thicket:	The first section of the Woods, through which travelers pass in Chapter 2.
Woods Card:	There are 41 Woods Cards in the deck: 40 pre-designed cards, one Tutorial card. A Woods Card's function depends on when it is drawn in the game. If a Woods Card is drawn in Chapter 1, that card becomes your Character Card. If a Woods Card is dealt into the Path, it determines the spirit encounters in Chapters 2-4.
Words by the fire:	Words by the fire comprise the night phase of most encounters. The party gathers around the campfire to discuss the day. This is a time for roleplay, character development, and interaction. A traveler may withdraw from conversation at any time by saying: "I go to sleep." When all travelers are asleep, the day is over